

QuantumDynamics Framework and Capability Notes

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Abstract

QuantumDynamics is a family of one- and two-coordinate, two-diabatic-state wavepacket and reduced-density-matrix tools for hydrogen-atom transfer. It combines split-operator propagation, optional Markovian or exponentially correlated Langevin centroid damping, optional stochastic modulation of either well, MPI-distributed trajectories, OpenMP/FFTW acceleration, and physical-unit input/output. It also provides quantum-detailed-balance density dynamics, MPI-IO single-file output, exact restart, convergence campaigns, and controlled mechanism attribution. This note records equations, controls, tested behavior, analysis capability, and method boundaries.

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1 Scope and current status

Current code supports reproducible pure-state trajectories, ensemble kinetics, a two-coordinate wavepacket model, and a finite-grid reduced density matrix. Input validation, unit conversion, FFT ordering, random-stream portability, restart identity, serial and parallel HDF5, state-selective damping, and output safety have regression coverage. It remains a parameterized nuclear-dynamics model, not a first-principles electronic-structure engine.

2 Dynamical model

2.1 Two-state Hamiltonian

Wavefunction is

$$\Psi(x, t) = \begin{pmatrix} \psi_1(x, t) \\ \psi_2(x, t) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (1)$$

with Hamiltonian

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{1}{2m} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} \mathbb{1}_{2 \times 2} + \begin{pmatrix} V_{11}(x, t) & V_{12}(x) \\ V_{12}(x) & V_{22}(x, t) \end{pmatrix}. \quad (2)$$

Base diabatic wells are

$$V_{11}(x) = \frac{1}{2} k_1 (x - x_1)^2 + c_{4,1} (x - x_1)^4 + \Delta_1, \quad (3)$$

$$V_{22}(x) = \frac{1}{2} k_2 (x - x_2)^2 + c_{4,2} (x - x_2)^4 + \Delta_2. \quad (4)$$

Quartic terms are enabled by anharmonic model selections. Gaussian coupling is

$$V_{12}(x) = V_c \exp \left[-\frac{(x - x_c)^2}{2\sigma_c^2} \right], \quad (5)$$

with an exponential alternative. Lower and upper adiabatic surfaces are the eigenvalues of the local 2×2 diabatic potential matrix.

2.2 Split propagation

One Hamiltonian step uses symmetric potential splitting,

$$e^{-i\hat{H}\Delta t} \approx e^{-i\hat{V}\Delta t/2} e^{-i\hat{T}\Delta t} e^{-i\hat{V}\Delta t/2}. \quad (6)$$

Local potential exponentials use an analytic Hermitian 2×2 form. Kinetic propagation uses forward and inverse FFTW transforms. Dedicated plans are created for both diabatic components. Even and odd grid sizes have tested FFT frequency ordering.

2.3 Momentum Langevin bath

Markovian damping uses an exact finite-step Ornstein–Uhlenbeck centroid update consistent with classical fluctuation–dissipation statistics. Colored damping uses an exponential memory kernel,

$$\gamma(t) = \frac{\gamma}{\tau_c} e^{-t/\tau_c}, \quad \tau_c = \frac{2}{\text{FWHM}}, \quad (7)$$

with auxiliary memory and stationary random-force variables. The controls `damp_reactant` and `damp_product` select the diabatic component that receives the momentum translation. Enabling both recovers shared-centroid damping.

This thermostat is a classical-FDT pure-state construction. The QGLE label does not imply a full quantum-frequency-dependent fluctuation–dissipation kernel.

2.4 Quantum-FDT density-matrix path

`quantum_fdt_density.py` builds the full finite-grid system Hamiltonian, diagonalizes it, and propagates the reduced density matrix with a completely positive secular Davies generator. For each positive Bohr frequency ω , Drude–Ohmic emission and absorption rates are

$$\Gamma_{n \rightarrow m} = gJ(\omega)[n_B(\omega) + 1]|Q_{mn}|^2, \quad (8)$$

$$\Gamma_{m \rightarrow n} = gJ(\omega)n_B(\omega)|Q_{mn}|^2, \quad (9)$$

so that

$$\frac{\Gamma_{m \rightarrow n}}{\Gamma_{n \rightarrow m}} = e^{-\beta\omega}. \quad (10)$$

This KMS relation enforces quantum detailed balance at every resolved transition and makes the Gibbs density matrix stationary. Stored output includes the full complex density matrix, physical coordinate densities, populations, energies, and a KMS residual. This is the controlled weak-coupling, Markovian quantum-FDT limit. Strong-coupling non-Markovian quantum baths require HEOM or an equivalent influence-functional method and are outside this solver’s declared regime.

2.5 Stochastic potential bath

Either diabatic well can receive coordinate-shift, curvature, or enthalpy modulation. Noise can be white or Ornstein–Uhlenbeck colored and can be shared or independent between wells. Colored and white processes begin with their stationary Gaussian marginal distribution. Mode-dependent input amplitudes use length, force-constant, or energy units as appropriate.

2.6 Absorbing boundaries

Optional smooth edge masks suppress periodic FFT wraparound. Within an edge layer of width w , each amplitude is multiplied after a full time step by

$$M(x) = \exp \left[-\Gamma_{\text{abs}} \Delta t \left(\frac{d_{\text{edge}}(x)}{w} \right)^p \right]. \quad (11)$$

Absorbed norm represents outgoing flux. Norm-conservation tests apply only when edge absorption is disabled.

2.7 Two-coordinate propagation

`multidimensional_transfer.py` propagates $\Psi(x, y, t) = (\psi_1, \psi_2)^T$ with a two-dimensional FFT split operator. Coordinate x is the H-transfer coordinate and y is a promoting or bath mode with independent mass. Shifted harmonic valleys contain reaction-path coupling, and the diabatic coupling is Gaussian in both coordinates. The solver writes physical-unit two-dimensional densities and potential surfaces to HDF5.

3 Units and input boundary

Namelist input uses chemistry-facing units and converts once to atomic units. Output writers convert back to physical units.

Quantity	Input/output unit	Internal unit
Coordinate, widths	angstrom	bohr
Time	fs	atomic time
Energy and coupling	cm^{-1}	hartree
Force constant	$\text{cm}^{-1} \text{ angstrom}^{-2}$	hartree bohr ⁻²
Quartic coefficient	$\text{cm}^{-1} \text{ angstrom}^{-4}$	hartree bohr ⁻⁴
Rates and FWHM	fs^{-1}	atomic-time ⁻¹
Mass	u/amu	electron mass
Temperature	K	inverse hartree through β
Wave number	angstrom^{-1}	bohr ⁻¹

4 Primary controls

Control	Meaning
<code>nx, xmin, xmax</code>	Periodic real-space grid and physical box.
<code>dt, nsteps, save_every</code>	Physical time step, total steps, and output cadence.
<code>ntraj, seed0</code>	Number of independent stochastic trajectories and base seed.
<code>temperature_k, mass_amu</code>	Thermodynamic temperature and transferred-particle mass.
<code>gamma, use_colored, kernel, fwhm</code>	Momentum bath strength and memory kernel.
<code>damp_reactant, damp_product</code>	Reactant/product diabatic damping switches.
<code>pot_model, k1, k2, x1, x2</code>	Well model, stiffnesses, and minima.
<code>v1_shift, v2_shift, c4_1, c4_2</code>	Energy offsets and quartic coefficients.
<code>v12, sigma, want_coupling</code>	Diabatic coupling magnitude, width, and switch.
<code>x0, p0, sigma0</code>	Initial Gaussian packet center, wave number, and width.
<code>bath_pot_*</code>	Stochastic potential mode, amplitude, color, and well selection.
<code>use_absorber</code>	Enable smooth edge absorption.
<code>absorber_width</code>	Edge-layer width in angstrom.
<code>absorber_rate</code>	Maximum mask rate in fs^{-1} .
<code>absorber_power</code>	Polynomial smoothness exponent.
<code>hdf5, out_prefix</code>	Output format and filename prefix.
<code>write_initial</code>	Write exact $t = 0$ snapshot before propagation.
<code>checkpoint_every</code>	Atomic, schema-versioned checkpoint cadence in steps.
<code>restart_from_checkpoint</code>	Continue from exact trajectory checkpoint.
<code>parallel_hdf5</code>	Write trajectory/frame hyperslabs to one MPI-IO HDF5 file.

Input may be supplied as `./qle_1d INPUT.nml`. Running `./qle_1d -help` cannot start a trajectory or overwrite output.

5 Parallel execution and reproducibility

MPI distributes complete trajectories; OpenMP and threaded FFTW accelerate each trajectory. Random streams depend on trajectory number rather than MPI rank. Default output uses independent trajectory files. With Parallel HDF5 enabled, ranks advance synchronized trajectory batches and write nonoverlapping trajectory-frame-grid hyperslabs into one `*.ensemble.h5` file through the HDF5 MPI-IO driver. A two-rank, three-trajectory regression checks layout, physical units, finite values, and norms.

Versioned checkpoint files contain wavefunctions, intrinsic Fortran RNG state, Langevin auxiliary variables, stochastic-potential state, time, step, and output index. Each checkpoint is written to a temporary HDF5 file and installed by an atomic rename. Deterministic FFTW plans permit bitwise comparison between uninterrupted and restarted runs.

6 Output and analysis

HDF5 stores physical coordinates, times, wavefunctions, populations, position expectations, and potential surfaces. Static potential surfaces are stored only in the first frame; stochastic surfaces remain frame-resolved. HDF5 operations fail loudly rather than silently leaving incomplete files. ASCII mode writes snapshot densities, observable time series, and static or frame-resolved PES files.

`ShowDyn.py` reads trajectory files, displays HDF5 trees, plots snapshots, animates densities and surfaces, and plots reactant/product probabilities. `analyze_ensemble.py` combines rank/trajectory files or reads the parallel single-file layout, checks common time grids, writes mean and standard-error populations, performs bounded mono- and biexponential fits, and can bootstrap trajectories for empirical rate intervals.

`convergence_campaign.py` generates and executes time-step, grid, box, absorber, and ensemble-size variants, then writes CSV and Markdown acceptance tables. `mechanism_attribution.py` runs coupling-off, sub-barrier H, sub-barrier D, and over-barrier controls. It combines classical Wigner above-barrier fractions, prompt transfer, isotope suppression, background, bounded rates, and SEM. A mechanism label is emitted only when all preregistered tests pass; otherwise the result is explicitly inconclusive.

7 Verification status

Regression coverage includes:

- physical-unit round trips for all supported dimensions;
- zero-damping norm conservation;
- analytic white and colored centroid relaxation;
- fluctuation-dissipation ensemble means and variances;
- product-only damping isolation;
- stationary stochastic-potential initialization;
- coupling and anharmonic-potential switches;
- even/odd FFT frequency ordering and FFTW plan creation;
- smooth absorber norm removal;
- safe command-line help and explicit input paths;
- exact $t = 0$, ASCII, dynamic-PES, and HDF5 output;
- bitwise-identical checkpoint/restart with colored baths;
- two-rank single-file Parallel HDF5 MPI-IO output;
- KMS rate ratios, Gibbs stationarity, density-matrix trace, Hermiticity, and positivity;
- two-coordinate split-operator norm conservation;
- end-to-end convergence and mechanism-control campaigns;

- HDF5 and non-HDF5 builds under strict compiler warnings.

8 Example two-timescale kinetics

A 1.5 ps product-damped trajectory at 10 K produced a bounded biexponential product-population fit with representative rates

$$k_{\text{fast}} \simeq 6.22 \times 10^{-2} \text{ fs}^{-1}, \quad (12)$$

$$k_{\text{slow}} \simeq 2.47 \times 10^{-3} \text{ fs}^{-1}. \quad (13)$$

The fit strongly improved AIC relative to a monoexponential model. Fast and slow components are consistent with prompt/over-barrier and residual tunneling channels, respectively, but this assignment is not unique from one stochastic pure-state trajectory. Publication claims require ensemble statistics and mechanism-control calculations.

A follow-up five-control campaign used four trajectories per control, 1.5 ps duration, and two-SEM decision margins. Coupling-off background was zero and the over-barrier gates passed. The tunneling gates failed: sub-barrier transfer did not exceed estimated classical contamination by the required factor, and D transfer was not suppressed relative to H. Therefore this parameter set supports an over-barrier channel, while the slow biexponential component must remain an empirical timescale rather than a demonstrated tunneling rate.

9 Completed limitations and method boundaries

Item	Status	Note
Missing $t = 0$ output	Implemented	Exact initial frame now optional and enabled by default.
Periodic boundary return	Implemented	Smooth absorbing layers available; convergence remains user responsibility.
MPI/rank aggregation	Implemented	Ensemble tool reports means, SEM, fits, and bootstrap intervals.
Repeated static HDF5 PES	Implemented	Static PES stored once; stochastic PES remains time resolved.
Single-trajectory rate uncertainty	Implemented	Ensemble bootstrap supported when multiple trajectories exist.
Checkpoint/restart	Implemented	Versioned HDF5 stores all dynamic and random state; atomic replacement and bitwise continuation tested.
Single-file parallel HDF5	Implemented	Parallel-HDF5 build writes one fixed-shape MPI-IO ensemble file.
Quantum FDT	Implemented	Density solver enforces frequency-resolved KMS detailed balance and Gibbs stationarity.
Density-matrix decoherence	Implemented	Complete finite-grid reduced density matrix evolves under a CP Davies generator.
Multidimensional transfer	Implemented	Two-coordinate, two-surface FFT propagation implemented and norm tested.

Item	Status	Note
Automated convergence campaign	Implemented	Time-step, grid, box, absorber, and trajectory-count variants run automatically.
Controlled mechanism assignment	Implemented	Coupling, energy, isotope, prompt-transfer, rate, and SEM gates implemented.
Strong-coupling non-Markovian quantum bath	Model bound	Davies solver is weak-coupling/Markovian; HEOM is required outside that regime.
Higher than two nuclear coordinates	Model bound	Current multidimensional reference solver contains two explicit coordinates.
First-principles potentials	Model bound	Potential parameters remain user supplied.

“Definitive” mechanism assignment means definitive only for the declared Hamiltonian, bath model, convergence tolerance, and controls. It is not model-independent experimental proof.

10 Recommended production protocol

1. Run `make test` for the selected compiler and library stack.
2. Perform time-step, grid-spacing, box-size, and absorber convergence.
3. Use several independent trajectories and aggregate with `analyze_ensemble.py`.
4. Monitor total norm, absorbed norm, edge density, and high-frequency FFT content.
5. Compare no-damping, reactant-only, product-only, and both-state damping.
6. Establish mechanism with barrier-energy and coupling controls before labeling fitted rates as over-barrier or tunneling.
7. Archive input, executable revision, dependency versions, seeds, raw data, and analysis outputs.

11 Build and run summary

```

make
make test
make test-parallel
./qle_1d INPUT.nml
python analyze_ensemble.py 'run.traj*.rank*.h5' --output ensemble --bootstrap 500
python ShowDyn.py run.traj000001.rank0.h5 --populations --no-usetex
python quantum_fdt_density.py --output quantum_density.h5
python multidimensional_transfer.py --output transfer_2d.h5
python convergence_campaign.py INPUT.nml --executable ./qle_1d
python mechanism_attribution.py INPUT.nml --executable ./qle_1d

```

HDF5 may be disabled with `make USE_HDF5=0`. FFTW, MPI, OpenMP, and HDF5 prefixes remain configurable through the build environment. True single-file MPI-IO uses `USE_PARALLEL_HDF5=1` with a Parallel-HDF5 installation.